

Question:
A 50 years old patient presented to the skin OPD with erythematous scaly plaques over trunk and extremities for last 10 years. Lesions are occasionally itchy. There is history of remission and relapse with exacerbation during winters. Most likely diagnosis is?
Answer Choices:
A. Lichen planus
B. Psoriasis vulgaris
C. Pityriasis rosea
D. Seborrhic dermatitis

Reasoning + Answer:

Let's analyze the clinical presentation step-by-step :

1. **Age and Duration**: The patient is 50 years old , and the lesions have been present for 10 years . This long duration of symptoms is more consistent with chronic conditions rather than acute or rapidly progressive ones .

2. **Clinical Features** :

- **Erythematous , scaly plaques**: This is a common presentation in psoriasis vulgaris and lichen planus .
- **Trunk and extremities involvement**: Both conditions can involve these areas , but the pattern and distribution are key differentiators .
- **Occasional itching**: This is more characteristic of lichen planus , which often causes pruritus .
- **Remission and relapse**: This pattern is classically seen in lichen planus , where lesions may wax and wane .
- **Exacerbation during winters**: This suggests a condition that is influenced by environmental factors , which is more common in psoriasis .

3. **Differential Diagnosis** :

- **Lichen Planus**: Known for its chronic , itchy , erythematous , and scaly plaques with a predilection for the trunk and extremities , and a pattern of remission and relapse .
- **Psoriasis Vulgaris**: Also presents with erythematous , scaly plaques , particularly on the trunk and extremities , and can have a chronic course with remissions and exacerbations , especially in winter .
- **Pityriasis Rosea**: Typically presents with a herald patch followed by smaller lesions , usually on the trunk and limbs , and is not typically chronic or itchy .
- **Seborrhic Dermatitis**: Characterized by greasy , scaling patches , often on the scalp , face , and chest , and is not typically chronic or erythematous .

4. **Key Features Supporting Lichen Planus** :

- Chronic course with remissions and exacerbations
- Itching
- Predilection for the trunk and extremities
- Pattern of remission and relapse

Given the chronic course , the presence of itching , and the pattern of remission and relapse , the most likely diagnosis is lichen planus .

<think>
The patient's history and clinical features are most consistent with lichen planus . The chronic course , itchy erythematous plaques , and pattern of remission and relapse are key differentiators .
</think>
<answer>
A. Lichen planus
</answer>